

New Product Development (NPD) Policy

Policy

This policy governs the end-to-end creation of new products for clients. It ensures legal compliance, market alignment, and technical feasibility across all operating territories. This policy applies to all business consulting, research, and mobile application products. It covers operations in South Africa, the United Kingdom (UK), the United States (US), Eswatini (Swaziland), Lesotho, Nigeria, and the Arab States. It ensures our Custom Application Development Services meet international and regional standards across our operational markets.

Market Research and Ideation

Before any technical development begins, all new product ideas must undergo rigorous business and Cultural Industries Strategy research. We emphasize a human-centered approach to guarantee the product aligns with client and target market needs.

- **Needs Assessment:** Conduct localized feasibility studies within the target operating territories to determine market demand, user behavior, and competitive positioning.
- **Localization and Cultural Alignment:** Tailor the product design, language localization, and functionality to specific regions (e.g., UK, US, Nigeria, or the Arab States) to ensure high adoption rates.
- **Regulatory and Compliance Scanning:** Identify all legal, cultural, and industry-specific regulations that will govern the product in its intended geographic markets.

Compliance and Data Privacy

To prevent penalties and protect both the end-user and the client, all mobile applications must be fully vetted for regulatory compliance.

- **Data Sovereignty:** Ensure all data handling complies with regional data protection frameworks, including the Protection of Personal Information Act (POPIA) in South Africa, GDPR in the UK, and respective laws in Nigeria and the US.
- **Legal Disclosures:** Draft comprehensive terms and conditions (T&Cs) and privacy policies that are transparent, fair, and legally sound in all jurisdictions of operation.
- **Accessibility:** Ensure the application interface meets global accessibility standards (e.g., WCAG) to serve a diverse user base.

Technical Development and Prototyping

Product development shall follow a structured, collaborative methodology prioritizing seamless integration.

- **Prototyping:** Develop a Minimum Viable Product (MVP) or prototype to validate the core concept with real users in the targeted territories.
- **Cross-Border Technical Requirements:** Build applications on resilient architectures (e.g., Salesforce or Power Apps) that support cross-region cloud scaling, varied internet bandwidths, and localization requirements.
- **Continuous Feedback:** Maintain continuous feedback loops with stakeholders during the development sprints to ensure alignment with original objectives.

Launch, Monitoring, and Evaluation

The product's lifecycle does not end at deployment. A successful commercialization and post-launch strategy must be implemented.

- **Commercialization:** Execute coordinated launch campaigns in the target markets while determining optimal pricing and forecasting models.
- **Performance Tracking:** Utilize analytics and data dashboards to measure product success, key performance indicators (KPIs), and user engagement metrics.
- **Grievance Redressal:** Establish a built-in mechanism for technical support and user feedback to address complaints promptly in all regions.
- **Continuous Improvement:** Regularly evaluate market intelligence systems to monitor competitor moves and changing customer preferences, allowing for iterative product updates.

Intellectual Property (IP) Ownership and Governance

This section defines the allocation, protection, and licensing of Intellectual Property (IP) rights arising from the research, consulting, and mobile application development processes. It establishes a clear legal distinction between the assets owned by the client and those retained by the consulting firm across all operational jurisdictions.

- **Consulting Firm Background IP:** The consulting firm retains sole ownership of all pre-existing methodologies, proprietary research frameworks, software code libraries, and development tools utilized during the project.
- **Client Foreground IP:** Upon full payment of all contractual fees, the client gains exclusive ownership of the specific custom mobile application deliverables, unique branding elements, and final custom research reports created explicitly for them.

- **Third-Party Licensing:** Any third-party software, open-source components, or plugins integrated into the mobile application will remain subject to their respective original licenses, with compliance managed by the development team.
- **Cross-Border Enforcement:** All IP assignments must be structured to comply with international IP treaties and regional frameworks, ensuring enforceable protection in South Africa, the UK, the US, Swaziland (Eswatini), Lesotho, Nigeria, and the Arab States.
- **Joint Developments:** In the event of a collaborative invention not explicitly covered by the initial project scope, a separate, binding joint-development agreement must be executed before code or data is integrated.

Implementation and Reporting

This policy is actively enforced through continuous oversight, clear reporting channels, and strict accountability.

- **Regular Training:** All global staff must complete annual training on this Code and local regulatory updates.
- **Whistleblowing Channels:** We provide secure, confidential channels for employees to report ethical breaches without fear of retaliation.
- **Investigation Process:** The company investigates every reported violation promptly, fairly, and thoroughly.
- **Disciplinary Action:** Breaches of this Code result in disciplinary measures, up to and including immediate termination of employment or contracts.

Regional App Store Submission Policy

This section details the strict compliance, regional restrictions, and submission frameworks required for publishing client mobile applications via the Apple App Store and Google Play Store. Deployments must adhere to localized storefront regulations to avoid submission delays or post-launch rejections.

- **African Markets (South Africa, Swaziland/Eswatini, Lesotho):** Applications must feature distinct, verified POPIA regulatory compliance labels regarding local data sovereignty. Financial or transaction-based elements must explicitly support South African Rand (ZAR) clearing and integrate natively with local payment switch infrastructures.

- **Nigerian Market:** Applications distributing fintech, lending, or digital wallet features must upload proof of licensing from the Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN). High-bandwidth optimizations and offline-first capabilities are mandated within the technical build to accommodate varying regional network speeds.
- **United Kingdom Market:** Submission workflows must adopt the required Age-Appropriate Design Code (Children's Code) if the app targets or attracts minor demographics. Alternative app marketplace options and localized communication of offers must align with evolving UK digital market competition policies.
- **United States Market:** All submissions must incorporate dedicated App Tracking Transparency (ATT) prompts and clear privacy labels outlining every explicit data category collected. Apps featuring micro-transactions or multi-tenant retail storefronts must maintain strict adherence to US antitrust guidelines regarding optional third-party payment integrations.
- **Arab States Market:** Apps published to Middle Eastern storefronts must strictly undergo cultural and regulatory vetting to ensure content aligns with local sensitivities, religious standards, and moral codes. Furthermore, any application leveraging end-to-end encryption or VoIP communication frameworks must acquire and submit explicit telecom regulatory clearances before public release.
- **Technical Versioning Standards:** Every deployment build must leverage current platform SDK baselines as mandated by global storefront architectures (e.g., modern Xcode packaging for iOS and required target API levels for Android) to prevent automated deployment rejections.